△ Consolidated PBY Catalina 1936

Origin USA

Engine 2 x 1,200 hp Pratt & Whitney Twin Wasp air-cooled 14-cylinder 2-row radial

Top speed 196 mph (314 km/h)

Available as both a pure flying boat and an amphibian, the Catalina had a truly remarkable range, albeit at a relatively slow speed. Catalinas saved thousands of downed aircrew during WWII, and were used as airliners.

△ Sikorsky JRS-1/S-43 1937

Origin USA

Engine 2 x 750 hp Pratt & Whitney Hornet air-cooled 9-cylinder radial

Top speed 190 mph (306 km/h)

Sometimes called the "Baby Clipper," its principal operator was Pan Am, although airlines in Brazil and Norway also used it. Two were sold to private owners, and the example once owned by Howard Hughes remains airworthy.

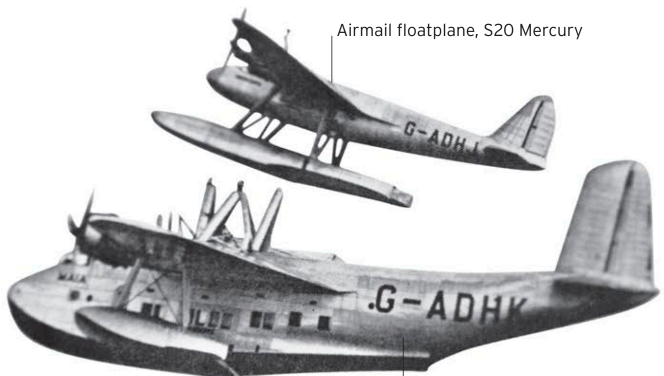
△ Shorts S25 Sunderland 1938

Origin UK

Engine 4 x 1,065 hp Bristol Pegasus air-cooled 9-cylinder radial

Top speed 213 mph (343 km/h)

Although loosely based on Shorts's S23 Empire Class flying boat, the Sunderland was significantly different from its civilian ancestor. The aircraft sank many U-boats during WWII.



◁ Shorts Mayo Composite 1938

Origin UK

Engine S21 Maia, 4 x 919 hp Bristol Pegasus air-cooled radial; S20 Mercury, 4 x 365 hp Napier Rapier air-cooled H-16

Top speed 212 mph (341 km/h)

This unusual machine was built to carry air mail. The smaller S20 Mercury floatplane was launched from the roof of a dedicated carrier aircraft, the S21 Maia. It did work, but advances in design soon rendered it redundant.

△ Boeing 314 clipper 1939

Origin USA

Engine 4 x 1,600 hp Wright Twin Cyclone air-cooled 14-cylinder 2-row radial

Top speed 210 mph (340 km/h)

Built by Boeing especially for Pan Am's Atlantic and Pacific services, at one point the 314 was the largest aircraft in the world. Only 12 of these magnificent aircraft were built, with three being operated by British Overseas Airways (BOAC) during WWII. None survive.

◁ Supermarine Walrus 1939

Origin UK

Engine 750 hp Bristol Pegasus VI air-cooled 9-cylinder radial

Top speed 135 mph (215 km/h)

The Walrus was designed to be launched by a warship's catapult, and consequently was much stronger than it looked. Rugged and reliable, the Walrus saved countless lives as a search-and-rescue aircraft. Its wings folded for carrier storage.